



SIFTING MERITS AND FLAWS

While players can choose Merits and Flaws during character creation, don't fear awarding particularly good roleplay with these Traits. The heroic sidhe who passionately eliminates a gang of malicious Thallain as they attempt to slay her injured duke earns the Boon Social Merit, for a rating of anywhere up to four points if the threat was true and the duke particularly important. Similarly, the eshu who in the same battle had a cold iron blade run across his face may conclude the conflict with the Bad Sight Physical Flaw. A permanent scar is left as a reminder of the cost of defending the changeling's liege.

Flaws provide players new opportunities for roleplay, and experience points should be awarded alongside to remove the sting if the Flaw is particularly crushing. The Storyteller should keep in mind the negative impact a Flaw will have on a character, and arrange for a Merit, or some other reward, to follow later in the chronicle. This karmic cycle in the background of a chronicle leads to rewarding arcs for characters as they suffer tragedy one day, only to receive their just rewards later in the story.

Of course, the reverse is also true.



Ambidextrous (1pt. Merit)

You have a high degree of off-hand dexterity and can perform tasks with the "wrong" hand at no penalty. The rules for taking multiple actions still apply, but you do not suffer a difficulty penalty if you use two weapons or are forced to use your off hand.

Double-Jointed (1pt. Merit)

You're unusually supple. Reduce the difficulty of any roll involving body flexibility by two. Squeezing through a tiny space is one example of a use for this Merit.

Friendly Face (1pt. Merit)

You have a face strangers are inclined to trust. The effect doesn't fade even if you attempt self-deprecation, leaving you at -2 difficulty on all appropriate Social rolls (yes for first impressions, no for Intimidation, for example) when a stranger is involved. This Merit only functions on a first meeting.

Poison Resistance (1pt. Merit)

It could be you've a natural resistance, or perhaps you've built up your defenses against all known types of poisons. Any time you need to make a soak roll against the effects of a poison or toxin, reduce your difficulty by three.

Wheelman (1pt. Merit)

You have a natural affinity for driving motorized wheeled vehicles. The difficulties of all rolls requiring risky or especially difficult driving maneuvers are reduced by two.

Crack Shot (2pt. Merit)

Whether pointing a gun, arrow, or dart, you hit your target with great accuracy. You receive no increased difficulty when targeting any specific location and reduce the difficulty of rolls not involving specific targeting by one.

Dexterous Toes (2pt. Merit)

Anything you can do with hands (firing a gun, drawing, playing a musical instrument, etc.) can be done just as well using your feet. Polite society tends to frown on such behavior, but sluagh and pooka laugh at such prissiness.

Granite Skin (2pt. Merit)

A Trait held most commonly by trolls and redcaps, Granite Skin is quite literally an epidermal layer of thin, hard stone. You're a great deal tougher than you might be normally, but have the undesirable effect of leaving small flakes of stone behind every time you bend or flex. You possess the equivalent of chainmail armor at all times (see p. 285). Granite Skin does not cause a Dexterity penalty, but does impose a +1 difficulty to all rolls involving moving quietly.

Murderous Mien (2pt. Merit)

Something about your mien screams danger. Previous infamies mark your appearance like open wounds. With a look or gesture, you can terrify another changeling into obedience. Any rolls you make to threaten or coerce changelings and faetouched humans have their difficulties reduced by three. Other beings find you unsettling, imposing a +1 difficulty to attempts at charming.

Night Sight (2pt. Merit)

Night blinds many eyes, but not yours. Regardless of the lighting conditions, your eyes adjust automatically, so you can see equally well at high noon, midnight, or entering pitch darkness. The adjustment is instantaneous, so if you are standing in a dark room and someone lights a candle, you're not blinded.

Surreal Beauty (2pt. Merit)

You possess a beauty far beyond that of normal mortals, unsettling in its perfection. People stand in awe of your ideal, yet alien, form while an inexplicable nausea subconsciously rises to the fore. Reduce the difficulty by three on any roll in which you try and acquire a changeling or faetouched individual's attention, or win them over with your looks. Other beings find your beauty unnatural, imposing a +1 difficulty on attempts at winning such a person's trust.